

- Fidelity US Bonds Index Fund (Symbol: FSITX)
- Schwab US Aggregate Bond Index Fund (Symbol: SWAGX)

The 4-fund portfolio. This investing strategy involves investing in a total stock market or broad market fund, a bond fund, an international stock fund, and an international bond fund. If you want even more diversification than a 3-fund portfolio, this strategy adds an international bond fund. While there are not many international bond funds to speak of, a popular one is the Vanguard Total International Bond Index (Symbol: VTABX).

The 5-fund portfolio. This investing strategy involves investing in a total stock market or broad market fund, a bond fund, an international stock fund, an international bond fund, and a REIT fund (Real Estate Investment Trust). Again, this is another way to add even more diversification and additional asset types. As discussed earlier, REITs are Real Estate Investment Trusts and the underlying assets in the portfolio are real estate properties—assets outside of the stock and bond markets. REITs are a great way to invest in real estate without having to physically deal with the property or tenant issues. REIT index funds aggregate multiple different kinds of REITs focusing on different property types, for instance, shopping malls and retail spaces, industrial and office buildings, hotels and resorts, technology and data centers, hospitals, storage facilities, and so forth. Some popular REIT funds include:

- Vanguard Real Estate Index Fund (Symbol: VGSLX)
- Fidelity Real Estate Index Fund (Symbol: FSRNX)

(You may also choose to substitute the international bond fund with a REIT fund in the 4-fund portfolio strategy).

The ultimate goal when it comes to investing is for your money to grow. As a reminder, you can build these portfolios with either index funds or ETFs. It is common for investors to use ETFs in taxable accounts due to better tax treatment and index funds in tax-deferred retirement accounts.